

It is some time in the future. Technology has greatly increased people's ability to "filter" what they want to read, see, and hear. With the aid of the Internet, you are able to design your own newspapers and magazines. You can choose your own programming, with movies, game shows, sports, shopping, and news of your choice. You mix and match.

You need not come across topics and views that you have not sought out. Without any difficulty, you are able to see exactly what you want to see, no more and no less. You can easily find out what "people like you" tend to like and dislike. You avoid what they dislike. You take a close look at what they like.

Critics of the phenomenon believe giving us the power to "become our own editors" will encourage insulation and bias. But we have always been our own editors. Every time we consume media, we make choices, consciously or not. When we skip articles, choose one newspaper over another, switch television channels, or tune in to a radio station we decide what we want to consume. The Internet has simply provided tools to make the selection process broader, easier and better structured.

If and how you 'personalize' your news experience is simply a question of new methods, not new habits.

When readers actively select their own topics, as they do on [DailyMe.com](https://www.dailyme.com), for example, they are typically more engaged, not less, than those who rely solely on the editorial choices made for them in traditional outlets. Specifically, DailyMe.com users who personalize their news view an average of seven pages per visit, or about double the pages viewed by non-registered users.

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